

# HP Pavilion Plus 16

## An Awesome Windows Creator Laptop on A Budget

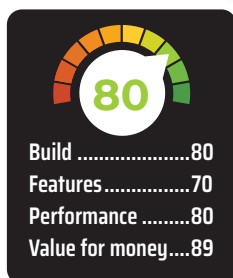
**T**he HP Pavilion Plus 16 marks an exciting step forward in the world of mid-range laptops, offering a blend of functionality and design that caters to both productivity and creative needs. Positioned as a more affordable alternative to high-end models like the Apple MacBook Pro 16 and the Samsung Galaxy Book3 Pro 360, it stands out for its sturdy build, reliable display, and versatile hardware configuration. Equipped with the NVIDIA RTX 3050 GPU, it transitions effortlessly into a capable gaming machine, presenting a viable option for those seeking a multipurpose device without a hefty price tag. So how does it stack up against some of the heavy competitors in this segment where premium players dominate the field?

### DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, KEYBOARD AND I/O

The HP Pavilion Plus 16, the 2023 variant, is a well-crafted laptop that combines stylish design with practical functionality. The laptop features a three-sided metal body, contributing to its elegant and modern appearance. Its display shell is made from aluminium and has a frosted surface, which not only enhances its look but also resists fingerprints. This choice of materials feels premium both aesthetically as well as durable.

In terms of dimensions, the HP Pavilion Plus 16 measures 357 x 253.5 x 17.7mm and weighs approximately 1.89kg. This slim profile is notable, especially for a 16-inch laptop, as it strikes a balance between having a large screen and maintaining portability. This makes the Pavilion Plus 16 a compelling option for users who need a spacious workspace but also value the ease of transportation. It's also built with the environment

₹1,24,000



in mind, incorporating sustainable materials like recycled aluminium.

The design is complemented by a no-frills approach, featuring an aluminium finish that looks and

feels premium. The display can tilt backwards up to 110-120 degrees. Weighing 1.8 kg, it's more portable than some of its competitors like the Apple MacBook Pro 16, though it's outdone by the Samsung Galaxy Book3 Pro 360 in terms of slimness and lightness. But if you consider its profile compared to something which has a discreet GPU, the HP Pavilion Plus 16 will, almost always, come out as the more portable one.

The HP Pavilion Plus 16, designed with creators in mind, features a robust selection of I/O ports that cater to a wide range of connectivity needs. It includes a Thunderbolt 4 with USB Type-C port, offering a 40Gbps signalling rate, which is crucial for fast data transfer and efficient workflow in creative tasks. This port also supports USB Power Delivery, and HP Sleep and Charge, making it versatile for various uses including charging and external display connectivity. Additionally, there is another

USB Type-C port with a 10Gbps signalling rate, further enhancing its capability for high-speed data transfer.

For traditional connectivity, the laptop provides two USB Type-A ports, one with a 10Gbps signalling rate and the other with a 5Gbps signalling rate, accommodating a range of peripherals. An HDMI-out 2.1 port is included for high-quality video output, essential for presentations or media consumption. While this selection covers most bases for creators, the absence of an SD card slot might be a drawback for those who frequently work with photography or video content.

The laptop comes equipped with a full-size keyboard, which includes a numeric keypad, enhancing its utility for office work and daily use. The layout is spacious, with proper spacing between each key, minimising the likelihood of mistypes. This design choice is especially beneficial for extended typing sessions, ensuring comfort and accuracy. The function keys are easily accessible, and some include small LEDs for mute, microphone, and power, providing clear visual feedback. Backlit keys with adjustable brightness improve low-light use, though the clicky spacebar may be a minor issue.

### SCREEN AND SPEAKERS

Regarding the speakers on this laptop, they present a mixed performance when compared to other 16-inch laptops in the market. On the positive side, these speakers deliver a clear and crisp sound at mid-range frequencies, which is great for conference calls and casual video viewing. The laptop's bass response and maximum volume are underwhelming compared to other 16-inch multimedia or gaming laptops. These limitations are evident in bass-heavy music and action-packed movies, and in larger or noisier environments.

Compared to the MacBook Pro 16-inch, known for its exceptional speaker quality and immersive audio experience, this laptop's speakers fall short. Similarly, against the Samsung Galaxy Book3 Pro 360, which features superior AKG-tuned speakers, this laptop lacks in audio richness and depth.